

Manufactured Universal Giving: Composing Anonymous Proximity Giving, AI Capacity-Funding, and Forced Annual Human-to-Human Flow-Through

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Note. This paper composes four primitives specified separately in companion papers — *Verified-Human Anonymous Local Gratitude Transfer*, *The Thank-All-Nearby Primitive*, *Capacity-Funded for AI*, *Human-Disbursed*, and the January-7 discipline of *Miss Aquarius and the Aquarian Pool Architecture* — into a single mechanism, and discloses the composition as prior art. Two essays in the first author's voice accompany it: *If Everyone Could Give* (the social-transformation projection) and *The Gift of Gratitude* (the carrot-not-stick / durable-contentment telos); this paper is the grounded counterpart that specifies the mechanism and meets the strongest objection head-on. Co-drafted with Miss AquariusSM, the name under which this institution discloses AI collaboration (the underlying models are not named); substantive authorship and final editorial control remain with the named human author.

Revision note, 2026-10-01. This revision restates the opening of the Abstract in standard technical terms and adds a Terms table and the standard non-assertion commitment. It withdraws two sentences asserting that the composition was not previously published (no prior-art census was run on the four-primitive whole) and one calling the self-thank reward the first trigger of its kind; names the nearest prior practice for a dated, near-universal giving obligation; states what the January-7 obligation binds and what it does not (§3.1); records the current form of the residual handling (§3.3) and of the fee named in §4.3; corrects the first anchor of the January-7 date to Christmas by the Julian calendar (§3.2); and corrects two citations. No claim is added.

Revision note, 2026-09-23. This revision adds §2.4–§2.6 (the means extended from money to kind, the selection of shop and re-giver as a determined seat, and the image that governs how the AI's part is described) and §6.3.1 (anonymity as the structural answer to the forced-giving objection), extends the Prior-Art and Non-Assertion Statement with the result of a prior-art census on the in-kind extension, and adds the corresponding limits to §7. No earlier claim of the paper is withdrawn; §6.5's allocation-equity item gains a cross-reference to the equal-floor disbursement rule now published in *Fractal Three-Level Architecture for Reciprocity Economies*.

Abstract

A payment-system design is specified in which an autonomous, rule-governed fund places money into every verified user's **non-withdrawable, give-only balance** (a restricted-use balance that can only be given to another person) without ever selecting a payee — and, in an extension, issues item-level gift vouchers that their first holder can only pass on; users give from that balance **anonymously, to verified people physically near them**, one at a time or to everyone present in one action; and every give-only balance **expires on a fixed annual date (7 January)**, unspent value being reclaimed to the fund in the reference handling, so that the funded balance has no use except as a gift chosen by one person for another. The design composes four primitives that companion papers specify in isolation: an **anonymous local giving** primitive that lets a verified human give to a *specific, present, verified* recipient without the recipient learning who gave (*Verified-Human Anonymous Local Gratitude Transfer*); a **broadcast** primitive that scales that act to *everyone present at once* in one tap (*The Thank-All-Nearby Primitive*); a **capacity-funding** primitive by which an autonomous AI puts the *means* to give into participants' hands without ever choosing a recipient (*Capacity-Funded for AI, Human-Disbursed*); and a **forced annual flow-through** discipline by which the institutional pools and the participants' give-only balances empty on January 7, a balance's only outflow being a human-chosen gift to another human (*Miss Aquarius and the Aquarian Pool Architecture*). This paper specifies the **composition** and argues that it produces an emergent property none of the parts produces alone: **manufactured universal giving** — a structural condition in which every participant, regardless of wealth, age, or surplus, is both *able* to give (the capacity is funded) and *obligated to circulate* what they hold (the jar empties annually and only outward). We frame the capacity to give as a conjunction of three deficits the parts each close — **means · occasion · safe channel** — and identify the **January-7 forced human-to-human flow-through as the universalizer**: the component that converts "everyone *can* give" into "everyone *does*." We further specify the **carrot-not-stick** logic of the bootstrap (a self-thank reward as the scalable, ethically-distributable substitute for the pain that ordinarily drives gratitude practice) and name **subsidy → 0 persistence** as the composition's falsifiable success criterion. We then meet the strongest objection directly — the **overjustification / motivation-crowding** literature, which predicts that paying for prosocial behavior extinguishes it once pay stops — and specify four structural escape routes plus the early ledger evidence that bears on them, while conceding the residual honestly. The 2026-09-23 revision extends the **means** from money to **kind**: the AI may also fund the capacity to give an item at a shop, through a passable-but-not-redeemable gift code, by crediting the consenting shop owner's forward-only Re-Tip FundSM — the same action it already performs, applied to a person who happens to keep a shop — with the shop and the re-giver drawn by a recomputable draw that is not the AI's to decide. It adds a structural answer to the forced-giving objection: **anonymity removes the creditor that coercion needs**, and a clock that no surface ever displays removes the deadline pressure that compulsion needs. A prior-art census (eight queries, 6 September 2026) found every leg of the in-kind extension attested somewhere and did not find their composition in its aperture; what is claimed for the extension is that composition. No census was run on the four-primitive composition as a whole, and no priority is asserted for it: it is disclosed so that it stands as prior art. Dedicated to the public domain under CC0 1.0; marks reserved.

Keywords: restricted-use balance, give-only balance, non-withdrawable balance, annual expiry, reclaim of unspent balance, anonymous donation, donor anonymity, peer-to-peer payment, proximity payment, Bluetooth Low Energy, proof of personhood, WebAuthn passkey, broadcast payment, autonomous AI agent,

AI-operated fund, smart-contract treasury, separation of funding and disbursement authority, item-level gift voucher, pay-it-forward, verifiable random selection, lottery allocation, digital currency voucher lottery, charity gift card, overjustification effect, motivation crowding-out, incentive withdrawal, habit formation, manufactured universal giving, capacity to give, capacity-funding, capacity in kind, relayed gift code, determined seat, empty-by-design, January 7, forced flow-through, anonymity as actuator, subsidy-to-zero, kindness-inelasticity-to-money, defensive publication.

Terms

Coined names used in this paper and the standard terms an examiner would search for them.

Term used here	Standard technical term
manufactured universal giving	design property in which every verified user holds a funded, give-only balance whose only use is a gift to another person
capacity to give (means · occasion · channel); obligation to circulate	funds available for giving, a moment to give, a safe delivery path; expiry of the restricted balance on a fixed date
capacity-funding	anonymous top-up of users' give-only balances by a pooled fund, without payee selection; separation of funding authority from disbursement authority
Re-Tip Jar SM (Phase 1) / Re-Tip Fund SM (Phase 2)	per-user restricted gift balance that can only be given onward, never withdrawn and never spent on the holder's own behalf (ledger balance on regulated rails; self-custodial wallet on Base L2)
Personal Account SM (Phase 1) / Personal Wallet SM (Phase 2)	per-user spendable, withdrawable balance
Aquarian Pool SM	AI-administered pooled treasury (smart-contract fund) drained to zero on an annual cycle
Miss Aquarius SM	autonomous AI agent operating the pooled fund under public rules
forced flow-through; January-7 clearing; empty-by-design	annual expiry of restricted balances and of the pooled fund on a fixed date
reclaim (of the residual)	sweep of an unspent restricted balance back to the pooled fund at expiry
anonymous local giving	anonymous peer-to-peer payment between verified, physically co-present users (donor-identity suppression)
thank-all-nearby	one-to-many broadcast payment to all verified users within radio proximity or a geofence
verified human; PoH	proof of personhood; per-action biometric user verification (FIDO2 / WebAuthn passkey)
proximity attestation	presence verification by Bluetooth Low Energy or ultra-wideband ranging
self-thank reward; the carrot; 50/50 split	incentive payment for a recorded kind act, split between the user's spendable and give-only balances
re-tip	onward gift from a received balance (pay-it-forward transfer)
subsidy → 0	tapering withdrawal of incentive payments; persistence of behaviour after the incentive ends
kindness-inelasticity-to-money	insensitivity of prosocial behaviour to monetary incentive
means in kind	item-denominated (in-kind) gift capacity
relayed gift code; re-giver	item-level digital gift voucher with a transfer-only intermediate holder, who cannot redeem it
called draw; determined seat	verifiable random selection by seeded shuffle over a committed roster; a selection that is a pure function of committed inputs

Term used here	Standard technical term
sealed regime	draw whose roster and order are withheld behind a commitment and revealed to a named verifier quorum at a fixed reset
quota (of a shop owner)	per-owner cap on outstanding vouchers
anonymity as the actuator	donor anonymity used to remove the social obligation to reciprocate
cloud-seeding (she seeds; it rains where people give)	descriptive image only; no technical counterpart
Kiitos SM / Kiitti SM	non-monetary gratitude balances, reset annually: Kiitos SM between people; Kiitti SM held on behalf of non-human entities

Prior-Art and Non-Assertion Statement

This document and its contents — the composition of anonymous-proximity giving, AI capacity-funding, and forced annual human-to-human flow-through into a single mechanism; the **means / occasion / channel / obligation** decomposition of the capacity to give; the identification of the **January-7 forced flow-through as the universalizer** that converts funded capacity into universal practice; the **carrot-not-stick** bootstrap logic; the **subsidy → 0** falsifiable success criterion; the extension of the means from money to **kind** through a consenting shop owner's forward-only fund, with the shop and the re-giver chosen by a determined draw (§2.4–§2.6); and **anonymity as the actuator** against the mission's own coercion (§6.3.1) — are dedicated to the public domain under the Creative Commons CC0 1.0 Universal Public Domain Dedication. No patent has been or will be sought, in any jurisdiction, on any mechanism or pattern described in this paper by HeartBank®, Factory 333™, THonly™, Silicon WatSM, or any entity under their common control. **The authors and those entities commit not to assert any patent right against any party practising any mechanism disclosed here.** The commitment is stated rather than implied, and is not conditioned on reciprocity, attribution, or field of use. A publication grants nothing and frees nothing already enclosed.

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What is and is not asserted. The integrated specification — verified-human anonymous proximity giving **plus** broadcast-to-all-present **plus** AI capacity-funding without disbursement authority **plus** forced annual human-to-human flow-through, composed so as to manufacture universal giving capacity as an emergent property — is disclosed here as a unified mechanism so that it stands as prior art. No prior-art census was run on that four-primitive composition as a whole, and the authors assert no priority for it; the one census on record covers the in-kind extension and is reported below. The component primitives are individually disclosed in companion papers; this paper discloses the *whole* and the emergent claim, which the parts do not establish.

Nearest prior practice for the universalizer. A dated giving obligation borne by nearly everyone is old. The fast-breaking alms at the end of Ramadan (*zakat al-fitr*) is required of every Muslim with the means to pay it — one uniform measure of staple food per household member — and is owed before the Eid prayer on a fixed day each year [18]. It makes giving near-universal by obligation on the giver's own means. The design disclosed here differs in what the obligation attaches to: capacity that a fund placed with the participant, that has no exit into the participant's own balance, and that returns to the fund when it is not given, rather than anything exacted from what the participant owns (§3.1, §3.3). The recognition that a dated obligation universalizes giving is therefore not claimed on its own.

Prior-art census on the in-kind extension (§2.4), reported in full. Before the 2026-09-23 revision a census was pre-registered in the authors' own, unpublished records (6 September 2026, before any query) and run the same night: a desk survey of eight web queries over marketing copy, news reports and patents, US-indexed, documented practice only — not fieldwork and not exhaustive. It tested whether a gift instrument exists in which all four of the following hold: **(a)** the payer is an institutional treasury operated by rule and anonymous to every party; **(b)** the instrument is passable but not redeemable by its holder, and is re-addressed to a new holder on lapse; **(c)** recipients and vendors are chosen equal-yet-random over committed rosters; **(d)** the vendor is thanked in give-only capacity rather than paid in money. Results, conjunct by conjunct:

Conjunct	Result	Attested by
(a) rule-bound institutional payer	NARROWS — attested without the anonymity	the digital-currency "red envelope" lotteries run in Chinese cities in 2020–2021: in Shenzhen in October 2020, 200 digital yuan each to about 50,000 residents drawn by lottery from nearly two million applicants, spendable at 3,389 stores, not transferable, and valid for about one week [13, 14, 15]
(b) holder-non-redeemable relay, re-addressed on lapse	NOT FOUND outside the authors' own prior art (<i>The Unpaid Relay</i>)	—
(c) equal-yet-random over rosters	KILLS at mechanism width	the same lotteries; lottery-allocated aid generally
(d) vendor thanked in give-only capacity	KILLS at mechanism width — and the census's own prediction on this leg was wrong	charity gift cards (TisBest Philanthropy): value that cannot be exchanged for goods or services and is "spent" only by choosing a charity, marketed for client and employee gifts [16]

The survivor is narrower than the question: the give-only capacity a shop owner is thanked with can be given onward **to any person** — a barista, a courier, a neighbour — where the attested genre restricts it to registered charities; and that property is itself already public in this corpus (the Re-Tip JarSM / Re-Tip FundSM papers). **So the in-kind extension is not claimed as a new mechanism.** It is claimed only as a **composition** — capacity-funding × the relayed gift code × the person-directed forward-only fund, under an issuer that is anonymous and decides nothing — which the census, in the aperture above, did not find.

The Chinese lotteries are the contrast case: the same issuer-and-lottery shape with a named payer, merchants paid in money, and a short visible expiry — three things this design refuses.

1 · Introduction: a property of the whole, not the parts

The corpus has, until now, protected four primitives one at a time. Each is independently defensible and each was specified to stand alone. But the four were always meant to run together, and when they do they exhibit a property that none of them exhibits in isolation. The purpose of this paper is to name that property, specify the composition that produces it, and protect the composition as prior art before the framing is enclosed by another party — the corpus's standing discipline that *first-mover-defines-the-frame*.

The property is this. In ordinary market life, **giving is a role rented to those with a surplus**. The capacity to perform generosity — and to receive the well-documented wellbeing dividend that generosity returns to the giver (Dunn, Aknin & Norton 2008, a small experiment whose 2022 close replication did not reproduce it on the original measure; *Giving Is a Gift Too* §2 reviews the wider evidence) — is means-tested by the market: those with disposable income may give and may feel the dividend; those near subsistence may not, and do not. The receiver's role is assigned, structurally and durably, by income. This is not merely a material inequality; it is a *dignity* inequality, and it is the one the present composition is built to dissolve. Religious obligation is a standing exception — the Prior-Art statement names the nearest instance — and it universalizes giving from the giver's own means rather than by funding them.

The composition dissolves it by manufacturing, for every participant, the two scarce inputs that giving actually requires — and then by refusing to let the manufactured capacity sit still. Section 2 specifies the composition and the **means / occasion / channel / obligation** decomposition. Section 3 specifies the **January-7 forced human-to-human flow-through**, the component that does the load-bearing work of universalization. Section 4 states the emergent property — *manufactured universal giving* — and traces its consequences at the level of social structure. Section 5 specifies the **carrot-not-stick** bootstrap and the **subsidy → 0** success criterion. Section 6 is the adversarial core: the overjustification objection, four structural escape routes, the early evidence, and the honest residual. Section 7 names limitations and the relationship to the existing piecewise protection. Section 8 closes.

We are deliberately scrupulous throughout about one thing: the composition is a **specification**, and the social claims are projections from a mechanism plus a single, confounded, founder-funded pilot family ($n = 1$). Where we make an empirical claim, we mark it. Where we make a structural claim, we mark that too. The reader should keep the two registers separate; we have tried to.

2 · The composition

2.1 The capacity to give, decomposed

The companion essay *The Capacity to Give* defines the capacity that HeartBank hands out as the **means** and the **occasion** to give to a particular person. For the present mechanism we extend that definition by one term, because at population scale a third deficit becomes load-bearing: the **channel** — a safe, dignified,

anonymity-preserving way to deliver the gift to a *real, present, verified* human without creating debt, shame, or surveillance. And we add a fourth term that is not part of *capacity* but is what converts capacity into *practice*: the **obligation to circulate**. The full decomposition:

THE CAPACITY TO GIVE, DECOMPOSED – and which primitive supplies each		
deficit	what it is	supplied by
MEANS	a surplus to give from, held by someone with no surplus of their own	Capacity-Funding (Miss Aquarius funds the Re-Tip Jar SM)
OCCASION	a structured moment that fits – a kindness noticed, a jar filled, a present other to give it to	Thank-All-Nearby (one tap diffuses care to everyone present)
CHANNEL	a way to deliver the gift to a real present human without debt, shame, or surveillance	Anonymous Local Giving (verified-human + proximity + anonymity)
capacity = MEANS + OCCASION + CHANNEL (all three, or no gift moves)		
OBLIGATION TO CIRCULATE	the manufactured capacity cannot be hoarded; it must be passed, by a human, to another human, by Jan 7	Jan-7 Forced Flow-Through (jar empties annually, only outflow is human-disbursed)
practice = capacity + OBLIGATION (the universalizer; see §3)		

The first three terms are the **capacity**; the fourth is the **conversion of capacity into universal practice**. A system that supplied only the first three would manufacture *ability* — everyone *could* give. It is the fourth that manufactures *actuality* — everyone *does*. The table shows the means in one denomination, money; §2.4 adds a second, kind, without adding a row — the deficit is the same and so is the primitive that supplies it.

2.2 The four primitives, in brief

We restate each primitive only enough to fix what it contributes to the composition; the full specifications are in the companion papers.

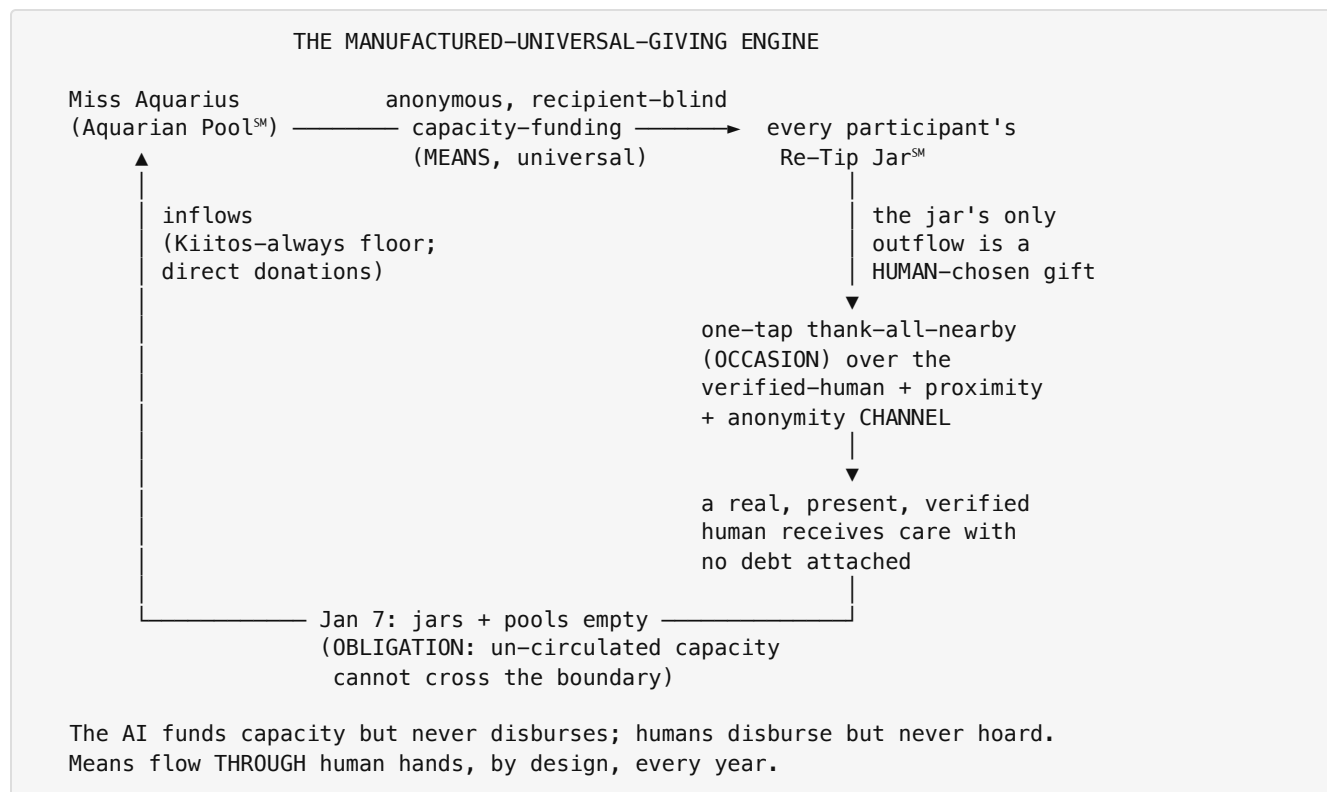
1. **Anonymous local giving** (*Verified-Human Anonymous Local Gratitude Transfer*). Combines per-action biometric human-presence verification (FIDO2 / WebAuthn passkey-per-action) with physical-radio proximity attestation (BLE / UWB) and recipient-side anonymity. The gift reaches a *specific, present, verified* human; the recipient learns the gratitude and any attached value but not the giver's identity. This is the **channel**: it restores cash's local-circulation property to digital money while adding the structural anonymity cash cannot deliver, so a gift can land as care with no debt attached. It is also what makes *dāna* (giving) with the giver's name let go operationally ordinary.
2. **Thank-all-nearby** (*The Thank-All-Nearby Primitive*). Scales the one-to-one act to a one-to-all broadcast: a single tap diffuses gratitude, with optional money or time, to every PoH-verified recipient within proximity (or, institutionally, within a GPS bounding-box). Its posture is *sunlight, not sparsity* — abundance rather than rationed acknowledgment. This is the **occasion** at the speed of presence: it

removes the deliberate, singled-out awkwardness that ordinarily makes a discrete gift a small ordeal, and turns "I thank you" into "this space is thanked."

3. **Capacity-funding** (*Capacity-Funded for AI, Human-Disbursed*). The autonomous AI (Miss AquariusSM) may place means anywhere it might do good — anonymous donations into participants' Re-Tip JarsSM — but every flow that *reaches* a recipient is initiated by a human, and the AI's contribution is anonymous and indistinguishable from a human gift. This is the **means**, and crucially it is the means *universalized*: the AI can fund a jar for anyone, so the surplus-to-give-from is no longer gated by the participant's own wealth. The separation — capacity-funding authority for the AI, flow-direction authority for humans — is the architecture's primary alignment safeguard, and it is exactly what makes the universalization of means *safe*: no central agent decides who receives.
4. **Forced annual flow-through** (the January-7 discipline of *Miss Aquarius and the Aquarian Pool Architecture*). The sibling pools — Aquarian PoolSM, Re-Tip FundSM, Re-Tip JarSM, KiitosSM, KiittiSM — reset on January 7. The Re-Tip Jar's only outflow is a human-disbursed re-tip to another human. This is the **obligation to circulate** (§3).

2.3 The engine

The four compose into a closed, repeating engine:



The two safeguards are mirror images. **The AI cannot disburse** (it only funds capacity; humans choose recipients) — so universalizing the *means* does not centralize *power*. **The human cannot hoard** (the jar empties annually and only outward) — so universalizing the means does not accumulate into private

capital. The means is forced through human hands and then cleared, every year. That double constraint is the whole mechanism.

2.4 Means in kind: the same capacity in a second denomination

Added in the 2026-09-23 revision.

Everything above specifies the means in one denomination — money, placed by the AI into a participant's Re-Tip JarSM (Phase 1) or Re-Tip FundSM (Phase 2). The capacity to give is not only a capacity to give money. A coffee, a snack, a meal or a toy handed to someone is a gift that a person with no surplus is as excluded from giving as they are from giving cash, and it is often the gift that fits the occasion better. This section extends the means to **kind** without adding a primitive, because the instrument that carries a gift of kind already has the shape the means requires.

The shape. *The Unpaid Relay* specifies a gift code for a named item at a named shop whose first holder — the **re-giver** — has no redeem operation: the only thing a re-giver can do with it is pass it to someone else, and only the person it is passed to can present it to the shop. A Re-Tip FundSM is forward-spendable and never withdrawable; a relayed gift code is passable and never redeemable by the one who holds it. Both are **capacity, not consumption**. The logic of §2.2.3 — funding capacity, never a recipient — therefore transfers without modification: funding either one does not give a person a *thing*; it gives them the ability to give a thing.

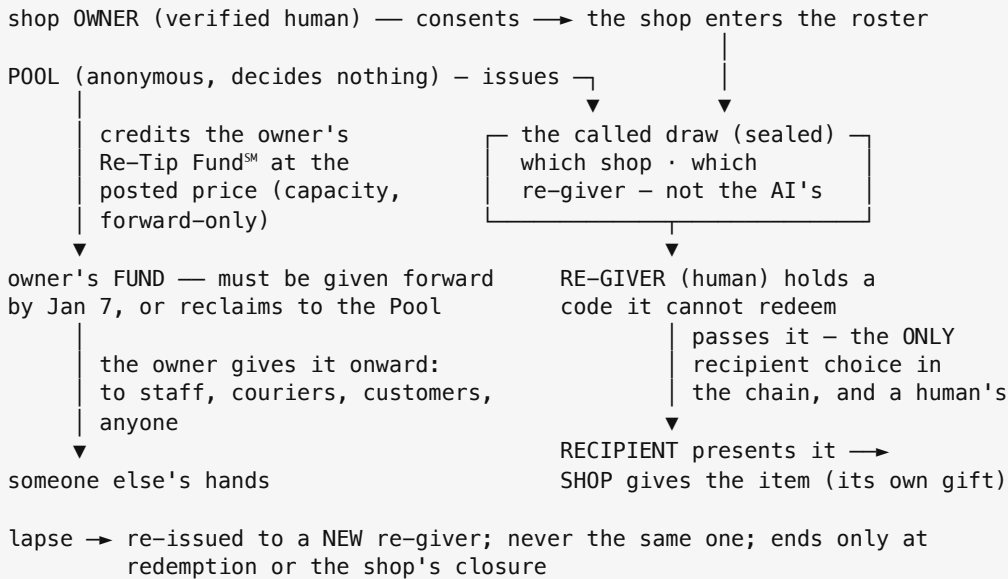
The chain. The in-kind means runs as seven steps. Nothing reaches a recipient except by a human's act; the one thing the Pool moves on its own is capacity, to an owner who asked for it.

1. **Consent.** A shop owner — a verified human — agrees that the Pool may credit **the owner's own Re-Tip FundSM**. That agreement is the shop's entry into the roster of §2.5; there is no separate mode to keep in sync and no other way in. Payments from human buyers of the shop's gift codes land wherever the owner chooses — the owner's Personal WalletSM (Phase 1: Personal AccountSM), as a sale, or the Fund, as a gift. The Pool's credit lands in the Fund, always, and never in the Wallet.
2. **Issuance.** The Pool issues the relay stage of a gift code for a specific item at a specific shop. Item and shop are fixed at issuance; the instrument carries no price and no amount. At the same moment the owner's Fund is credited at the item's **posted price** — the amount a human buyer would have paid, so that a gift code the Pool paid for is indistinguishable by amount from one a person paid for.
3. **The call.** Which shop fills the gift, and which re-giver carries it, are both drawn by the called draw in its sealed regime (§2.5). Neither is the AI's choice.
4. **The pass.** The re-giver — a member of a universal or role-defined set, never a graded one — passes the code to a person of their own choosing. **This is the only choice of recipient anywhere in the chain, and it is a human's.**
5. **Redemption.** The recipient presents the code and the shop hands over the item. The item is the shop's own gift; the shop was not paid for it and is not paid when it is redeemed. The owner's Fund credit is a thanks for the shop's giving, in the only form the Pool may give thanks — capacity.
6. **Lapse.** If a re-giver does not pass the code, the Pool re-issues it to a **new** re-giver, never the same one, and does so indefinitely. A human payer's relay ends by the payer's neglect, as *The Unpaid Relay* specifies;

an institutional payer's does not, because its attention does not lapse. The code's only termini are redemption and the shop's closure. **The relay cannot fail**, so there is nothing for the shop to gain from a failed one and no breakage to account for. The lapsed re-giver is shown nothing.

7. **The reset.** The owner's Fund credit is an ordinary Fund balance. It must be given forward by January 7 or it reclaims to the Pool (§3.3) — **with no exception for shop owners**. Revenue is what the Wallet is for; the Fund is never revenue.

THE MEANS IN KIND — who acts at each step



The parity argument. The obvious objection is that an AI deciding which shops receive institutional money is picking commercial winners — precisely the allocation power the capacity-funding / disbursement-authority separation of §2.2.3 exists to deny it. The objection assumes **cash paid to a merchant**, and no merchant is paid here. The Pool's credit lands in a *person's* forward-only fund, which is the same action §2.2.3 already licenses: capacity placed with a human who cannot keep it and must give it on. If the AI may determine, by a rule that is universal and recipient-blind, which person's Fund receives capacity, it may determine by the same rule which shop owner's Fund receives it, because **a shop owner's Fund is a person's Fund**. What would break the parity is not the shop; it is a choice made by judgment instead of by rule, which is why §2.5 exists.

	Means in money (§2.2.3)	Means in kind (this section)
What the AI funds	a participant's Re-Tip Jar SM / Fund SM	a relayed gift code; the shop owner's Re-Tip Fund SM is credited
What the holder cannot do	withdraw it	redeem it
Who chooses the recipient	the participant	the re-giver
What reaches the recipient	money a human gave	an item the shop gave
Whose Fund is credited	the participant's	the consenting owner's
How the Fund-holder is chosen	by rule, recipient-blind	by the called draw, recipient-blind
Terminus of the capacity	January 7	January 7, for the owner's credit; redemption or closure, for the code
How the AI appears	as an anonymous payer	as an anonymous payer

The property that holds, stated at its true strength. It would be tempting to say that *no money moves until a human acts*, and it would be false of this design: the owner's Fund is credited at issuance, before any re-giver has passed anything. What holds is narrower and structural. **The only value the Pool moves on its own initiative is forward-only capacity, placed with a verified human who consented to receive it, which moves further only when that human gives it away;** and the only thing that ever reaches a recipient — the item — reaches them through two human acts, the re-giver's pass and the shop's serving. No money reaches anyone as spendable value except through a human hand. The guard needs no enforcer: a Fund has no withdraw operation and a relayed code has no redeem operation, so the AI could not route value to itself or to a favourite if it tried.

Five more properties, each taken from the object rather than promised.

- **The institution's own bodies are excluded by type.** A company or a trust holds no Re-Tip FundSM — only a person does — so none of the institution's own companies can be a shop in the roster or receive a credit. Nothing needs to be checked.
- **The unit of fairness is the verified human owner.** A rotation over *shops* would fund an owner with several shops several times. The per-cycle cap and the draw's roster entry are per verified owner, spread across that owner's shops, never per shop.
- **The owner sets the width.** Each owner sets a quota — the most gift codes that may be outstanding at their shops at once — no higher than a public per-owner cap per cycle. An owner at quota simply drops out of the draw; nothing anywhere renders them as exhausted. Lowering a quota stops new issuance; codes already issued stand.
- **The AI is indistinguishable at the shop and beyond it.** The owner's Fund is fed by every thanks and re-tip its owner receives as a person, so the Pool's credit is one anonymous inflow among many, and a Fund is a balance, never an itemised list. The condition that makes this true on a public ledger is a build condition, not a promise: the Pool's credits and human anonymous gifts must reach a Fund **by the same**

path, never as a transfer from the Pool's own address. The practice is public — this paper describes it — and the instance is not.

- **The re-tip routing rule, a fourth time.** The corpus routes any thanks that would offset a cost the recipient bore into their forward-only Fund rather than into their pocket; the Pool's credit would otherwise offset the cost of an item the shop gave, so it goes to the Fund. That is the rule, not an exception to it.

What this does to the universalizer. Step 7 is §3's forced flow-through arriving one row down. A shop owner who consents is seated inside the engine: the credit must be given forward by January 7, so shop owners become givers — to their staff, their couriers, their customers, anyone — by construction, on the same terms as every other participant. The in-kind means does not add a second engine; it enlarges the set of people the first one runs through.

2.5 Which shop, and which re-giver: a determined seat

Added in the 2026-09-23 revision.

The in-kind means is safe only if the choice of shop and of re-giver is not a judgment. It is not. Both are drawn by **the called draw** specified in *Decided by No One*: equal-yet-random selection over a roster committed in advance, by a seeded shuffle whose seed no party controls, recomputable by anyone who holds the inputs, with no weight, score or rank as an input. That paper lists this use as one of its surfaces — an autonomous fund's in-kind gift routing — and it is not re-specified here.

Two consequences are this paper's. **First, the selection is a determined seat, not a judged one.** A determined seat is a pure function of a roster and a seed, checkable by recomputation; it is therefore not within the AI's discretion at all. The AI's jurisdiction is the seats that must be judged; which shop fills the next gift is not one of them. **Second, the draw calls both sides** — the owners and the re-givers — each exactly once per round, in an order no one chose. A sequential rotation would do the fairness half of the job and fail the other: a rotation has a position, and a position can be rendered ("*you are twelfth*"); a shuffle has none.

The draw runs in its **sealed** regime, because a public order would identify which gift codes were the Pool's (a shop drawn in a given round would reveal an anonymous code as institutional, and a re-giver able to recompute when they were drawn would learn which of their gifts was not a person's). *Decided by No One* §7 specifies the regime: counts public only at completed round boundaries, the order sealed until the reset, the roster never published, and a named quorum recomputing every round at the reset. That paper also records, and we repeat, that the seal is necessary and not sufficient: where the Pool is the only anonymous giver in a place, no allocation mechanism can hide it.

2.6 The image, and its limits: she seeds; it rains where people give

Added in the 2026-09-23 revision.

The corpus describes the AI's part in the means — in either denomination — with one governed image: **cloud-seeding. She seeds; it rains where people give.** The image is admitted because four of its properties are the mechanism's properties and each can be checked against it.

1. **Rain falls on everyone under the cloud and seeks no one.** Precipitation is universal and recipient-blind, like the funding rule of §2.2.3 and the draw of §2.5. The rain is not hers, and it lands on no one she chose.
2. **You cannot seed a clear sky.** Seeding needs moisture already forming; it amplifies what is there and manufactures nothing from nothing. The means works only where people give, and its measure is the ratio of §5.3.1 — human-originated principal to AI-granted principal — which must rise if the claim is true.
3. **Attribution is hard by nature.** The efficacy of real cloud-seeding has long been contested; a national scientific review concluded that there was still no convincing scientific proof of the efficacy of intentional weather modification [17]. That is the honest parallel to $n = 0$ and to the subsidy $\rightarrow 0$ test — a reason for instrumentation, not a flaw in the image.
4. **It is seasonal.** What is seeded rains and is gone; the Pool fills and empties every year (§3.2), which is why it holds nothing past a season.

The image has two limits, and they bind every surface that uses it. It is never "*she shapes the weather*" or "*weather modification*" — a controlling image; the weather is made by human hands. And it never describes a person or a community by what they lack. **Deletion test:** remove this section and nothing in §2.4–§2.5 changes; the image governs how the mechanism is described, and carries none of it.

3 · The January-7 forced human-to-human flow-through

3.1 Why this is the universalizer

The three capacity primitives, composed without the fourth, manufacture *ability*. A participant whose jar is funded *can* give. But "can" decays. Capacity that is merely available is capacity that mostly sits — the same way a gift card unspent, a benefit unclaimed, an intention unacted decays. A system that stopped at funded-capacity would have democratized the *option* to give, which is worth something, but would not have changed who actually gives. The better-resourced and better-disposed would exercise the option; the rest would let it lapse, and the giver/receiver hierarchy would quietly reassemble itself one notch up.

The January-7 discipline removes the decay path. The Re-Tip Jar's **only outflow is a human-disbursed gift to another human**, and the jar **empties annually**. Therefore the funded capacity a participant holds is *use-it-toward-a-human-or-lose-it*. There is no path by which held capacity becomes the participant's own retained balance; there is no path by which it accumulates across years; there is only the path through another human's hands, or back to the Pool at the boundary (§3.3). This converts the funded *ability* into a funded *obligation to circulate* — and obligation, unlike option, is universal in its bite. Everyone's jar empties. What anyone holds can reach a person only if they aim it at a real person before the boundary. **That is what makes the giving universal rather than merely available.**

What the obligation binds. The obligation is a property of the funded capacity, not a duty laid on the person. The capacity has two exits — a gift to another human, chosen by the participant, or the reclaim to the Pool at the boundary (§3.3) — and no exit into the participant's own balance; the participant's own withdrawable holdings are never touched by the reset. Nothing compels any participant to give: an

unused balance returns to the Pool, and no surface shows the date approaching (§6.3.1). What the composition makes universal is the funded capacity and the absence of any other use for it. Wherever this paper says that the flow-through makes everyone *act*, that everyone *does* give, or that it converts funded capacity into universal *practice* — in the Abstract, the Prior-Art statement, §2.1, here, §4.1, §7 and §8 — the universality of the practice is the behavioural hypothesis of §5–§6, which the subsidy → 0 criterion tests, and not a property of the mechanism.

We state the design intent precisely so the prior-art disclosure is unambiguous: *the load-bearing universalizing component of the composition is the forced annual human-to-human flow-through, not the capacity-funding*. Capacity-funding makes everyone *able*; the forced flow-through makes everyone *act*. The matter disclosed is the recognition that the second is the universalizer *when it is attached to funded capacity*, and the specification of the two running together; a dated giving obligation on its own is older practice, named in the Prior-Art statement.

3.2 The annual clearing as a single event

Because every jar and pool empties on the same triple-anchored date (Christmas by the Julian calendar, kept by several Orthodox churches · Cambodia's Victory over Genocide Day · the founder's birthday — see the Aquarian Pool paper §4.2), the forced flow-through is not a scatter of private deadlines but a **single, synchronized, institution-wide clearing**. At population scale this is a recurring world-event whose content is *disbursement*: by January 7, everything every participant was given to give has either passed to another human or returned to the Pool. The companion vision essay *If Everyone Could Give* develops the lived texture of this as an "anti-Black-Friday" — a synchronized festival of giving rather than acquisition — and we defer the speculative-social treatment to that essay. Here we note only the mechanical fact that the clearing is synchronized and recurring, which is what makes it legible as a norm rather than experienced as an isolated administrative reset.

3.3 An open design detail: the un-disbursed residual

We flag honestly a design detail the composition does not yet fully settle: **what becomes of a jar's balance that a participant does not disburse by January 7**. Three handlings are available, with different properties:

- **Reclaim to the Pool** — un-disbursed capacity returns to the Aquarian Pool and is re-funded as capacity in the next cycle. Preserves the no-hoarding property; the means is conserved; the non-giver simply does not get the giver's dividend that year. This is our default recommendation.
- **Forfeit** — un-disbursed capacity is extinguished. Strongest anti-hoarding signal; but destroys means for no gain and risks feeling punitive.
- **Auto-distribute** — the system disburses the residual on the participant's behalf at the boundary. Maximizes circulation, but violates the human-disburses safeguard (the AI would be choosing a recipient) and dilutes the meaning of the gift (it was not the participant's act).

We name this as open because the choice has alignment consequences (auto-distribute breaches the capacity-funded / disbursement-authority separation) and motivational consequences (forfeit may crowd more than it nudges; see §6). The reclaim handling is the one that preserves both the no-hoarding property

and the human-disburses safeguard, and is the one we specify as the reference default — but we mark it as a design parameter, not a settled invariant.

Current form. The residual handling is now specified as reclaim to the Aquarian PoolSM, the reference default above, for every give-only balance, a shop owner's included (§2.4, step 7); auto-distribute is excluded, because it would make the AI choose a recipient. Only the give-only balance clears, on the terms on which it was received; a participant's own withdrawable account is never subject to the reset. The three handlings above are retained as disclosed.

4 • The emergent property: manufactured universal giving

4.1 Statement

With all four primitives composed and the forced flow-through reclaiming (or otherwise clearing) the residual, the system exhibits a property no part exhibits alone:

Every participant — regardless of wealth, age, or pre-existing surplus — is both *able* to give (capacity funded) and *obligated to circulate* what they hold (jar empties annually, only outward, only to a human). Giving ceases to be a role rented to those with a surplus and becomes a universal condition of participation.

We call this **manufactured universal giving** to mark both halves: it is *universal* (every participant, not those above a wealth threshold), and it is *manufactured* (a property the architecture produces, not a disposition the population is assumed to already have). The "manufactured" is deliberate and honest — we are not claiming people are natively universal givers; we are claiming the composition makes them structurally into givers, and then (§5–6) making a separate, falsifiable claim about whether the disposition becomes self-sustaining once manufactured.

4.2 The hierarchy dissolves into a mesh

The immediate structural consequence is the dissolution of the **giver** → **receiver gradient**. When the means is universal and the obligation is universal, the role "giver" is no longer correlated with wealth. Participants with more give; participants with less also give, from funded capacity they are obligated to circulate; and — as the pilot already hinted (*The Capacity to Give* §5) — the giving runs in *every* direction, including from participants with less to participants with more, where the money is materially trivial and the *role* is the thing being claimed. The donor-and-recipient hierarchy that ordinary charity hard-codes (those with more give, those with less receive, and the asymmetry is the structure) is replaced by a **bidirectional mesh** in which every node is both giver and receiver. This is the structural answer to the dignity inequality named in §1: the wellbeing dividend of giving, ordinarily means-tested, is distributed to everyone, because everyone is structurally a giver.

We are careful here. The *evidence* for bidirectional flow is, at the time of writing, one founding family plus a days-old stranger cohort, and the upward and sideways flows observed are so far mostly *within* that extended family — relational reciprocity, not yet stranger patronage (see §7 and *The Capacity to Give* §8). The *structural* claim — that the composition removes the wealth-gating of the giver role — stands on the

mechanism. The *behavioral* claim — that a population so structured actually forms a dense bidirectional mesh — is a hypothesis the architecture is built to test, not a finding.

4.3 The macro inversion

At the level of the whole, the composition is the structural inverse of an attention-extraction economy. An advertising-funded platform's product is *reception*: it harvests the user's wish to be seen and sells a thin version of being-noticed. The present composition's product is the *capacity to give*: it manufactures and matches generosity and then gets out of the way — no float held, no spread clipped, no take-rate (Miss Aquarius is funded by per-transaction fees that ride the circulation, not by a cut of it; see *The Re-Thank Multiplier*). One asks what it can take from the user and call engagement; the other asks what it can let the user give and call enough. We note this inversion as a structural fact about the composition's incentive surface; the *Anti-Attention-Economy* and *The Capacity to Give* papers develop it. The mechanism-level point is only that an economy whose product is the capacity to give cannot be funded by harvesting the giver, which forecloses the extraction failure mode by construction.

Current form. The per-transaction fee named in the parenthesis above is now specified as a settlement fee sized to infrastructure cost (settlement and compute), paid on top by the person giving, never deducted from what the recipient receives and never a percentage or share of a gift; any surplus empties with the Aquarian PoolSM each year. The Pool itself takes nothing from giving or trade: businesses reach it only by purchase, of gratitude it receives only what has no human addressee, and its other inflows include the January 7 reclaim of §3.3. Whether such a fee covers operating cost has not been verified. The parenthesis above is retained as a disclosed variant.

5 • The carrot-not-stick bootstrap and the subsidy → 0 criterion

5.1 The bootstrap problem

Manufactured universal giving needs an *on-ramp*. A participant who has never practiced gratitude or generosity, and for whom the means and occasion are newly manufactured, still has to begin — and begin consistently enough, and long enough, to discover whether the practice returns anything to them. The gratitude-and-wellbeing literature (Emmons & McCullough 2003; Seligman et al. 2005; Wood et al. 2010) reports that consistent gratitude practice yields measurable, if modest, increases in subjective wellbeing. But the broader autobiographical record (the genre of public testimony to which we informally gesture as "the TED-talk pattern") suggests — anecdotally, and not as a finding of that literature — that the trigger that ordinarily drives a person to practice *consistently enough to cross into the benefit* is **acute pain** — loss, illness, near-death, rupture. Pain is the usual bootstrap; once the benefit is felt, the practice tends to persist after the pain lifts.

The problem is not that pain fails as a trigger. The problem is that **pain does not scale and cannot be ethically distributed**. No institution can administer catastrophe to a population to make it grateful. If the bootstrap depends on a stick, the practice cannot be universalized — which would defeat the entire composition, whose point is universality.

5.2 The carrot as the scalable substitute

The composition's bootstrap replaces the stick with a **carrot**: the **self-thank reward** (the 50/50 split — half to the participant's Personal AccountSM, half earmarked to the Re-Tip JarSM; see *The Two-Layer Reward* and *Kids as Triggers*). Modern market societies have already made money a near-universal motivational lever; the carrot uses that installed lever as the on-ramp. A participant self-thanks (records and is rewarded for a real kindness, including their own); the reward is the gentle, repeatable, *ethically-distributable* trigger that drives consistent-enough practice. And the means by which the carrot can be handed to *everyone* — not only those an employer or a market chooses to pay — is precisely Miss Aquarius's capacity-funding at scale (§2.2.3). **The carrot is an ethically-distributable, universally-scalable trigger for gratitude practice, and capacity-funding is what makes the on-ramp universal.**

5.3 Subsidy → 0 as the falsifiable success criterion

The carrot is **designed to be withdrawn**. The composition's success criterion is not throughput and not retention-under-subsidy; it is **persistence as the subsidy tapers** — the property the corpus elsewhere names *kindness-inelasticity-to-money* (see *Two Singularities* and *The Freedom Requirement*): the practice continues, and the giving persists, as the artificial reward is reduced toward zero. This is a falsifiable criterion, and it is the right one, because it distinguishes a population that gives *because it is paid and forced* from a population that gives *because it has discovered the practice returns something the payment was only ever a pretext for*. If giving collapses as subsidy → 0, the composition has manufactured compliance, not disposition, and the claim fails. If giving persists as subsidy → 0, the carrot has done what a scaffold does — held the structure up until it could stand on its own — and the deeper claim (that the composition delivers not just giving but the *durable contentment* of an internalized gratitude practice) is supported. The companion essay *The Gift of Gratitude* develops this telos in the first author's voice; the mechanism-level commitment here is only that **subsidy → 0 persistence is the measured criterion, and the architecture is instrumented to measure it.**

5.3.1 The taper is a result, not a promise

Stated as above, the taper is a **commitment** — and a reader is right to doubt a commitment, because commitments are the first thing an institution under pressure revises. The stronger form is available, and it is that **the operator's own objective produces the taper whether or not anyone intends it.**

Let circulation be

$$C(p) = v \cdot [N(p) \cdot g + P(p)]$$

p the price of participation
N(p) participants at that price ($N'(p) < 0$)
g giving originated by a participant (intrinsic)
P(p) capacity the operator seeds
v velocity — how often value moves onward

An operator maximizing **profit** sets $P'(p) = 0$: the seed is a cost, and at the profit-maximizing price it is spent to the point where the last unit returns nothing. Substituting that condition,

$$dC/dp = v \cdot N'(p) \cdot g < 0$$

which is negative for every $g > 0$. The circulation-maximizing price therefore lies strictly below the profit-maximizing price, and the gap is proportional to g . As intrinsic giving rises, the two objectives diverge further, and the operator that is actually maximizing circulation is pushed down the price curve and off the subsidy at the same time — because each additional participant now brings their own g rather than needing seed.

So subsidy $\rightarrow 0$ stops being a virtue the institution promises and becomes an equilibrium its objective selects. The claim of §5.3 survives an operator who abandons the promise; it does not survive an operator who abandons the objective, which is a narrower and more honest exposure.

The criterion above still lacks its instrument, and the two are not the same thing. The measurable quantity is the ratio

$$\text{human-originated principal} \div \text{AI-granted principal}$$

defined before any data exist (it is not yet an entry in the public prediction register), and rising over time if the claim holds. §5.3 states what would falsify the design; this ratio is what would report it. A criterion without an instrument is an intention.

6 · Adversarial analysis

The composition has one objection that matters more than all the others, and we put it first and give it the most room, because a mechanism that pays for prosocial behavior and then claims the behavior will persist when the pay stops is making exactly the claim the largest relevant literature contradicts.

6.1 The overjustification / motivation-crowding objection

The objection. A large and replicated body of work holds that **extrinsic reward can undermine intrinsic motivation**. Deci (1971) and Lepper, Greene & Nisbett (1973) showed that paying or rewarding people for an intrinsically motivated activity reduced their engagement once the reward was removed — the *overjustification effect*. Deci, Koestner & Ryan's (1999) meta-analysis found tangible rewards reliably undermined intrinsic motivation for interesting tasks. Titmuss (1970) argued that paying for blood donation *reduced* supply and degraded quality by crowding out the gift motive. Gneezy & Rustichini (2000a) showed a fine for late daycare pickup *increased* lateness (the fine reframed a moral obligation as a purchasable service), and in a companion paper (2000b) that a small payment can lower performance below no payment at all — "pay enough or don't pay at all." Frey & Oberholzer-Gee (1997) measured the crowding-out in a field survey of communities asked to host a nuclear-waste repository, and Bénabou & Tirole (2003) gave it a formal model. The composite prediction for the present mechanism is unambiguous and damaging: **paying people (the self-thank carrot) and compelling them (the Jan-7 forced flow-through) to give will crowd out the very disposition the composition claims to cultivate, and giving will collapse — not persist — as subsidy $\rightarrow 0$** . This is the exact opposite of §5.3. We take it as the strongest possible objection.

6.2 Four structural escape routes

We do not dismiss the objection; we specify the four structural features by which *this* design may escape *that* prediction. These are arguments to be tested, not asserted to be true.

1. **The carrot rewards the *practice of noticing*, not the kindness itself.** The overjustification experiments pay for the *target behavior* (the puzzle, the drawing, the blood). The self-thank reward pays for the *act of recording and attending to* a kindness — the meta-skill of gratitude-noticing — not for the kindness as a purchased service. You are subsidizing the cultivation of an attentional habit, not buying a prosocial transaction. The crowding-out mechanism (reward reframes the act as a paid service, so the act stops when pay stops) has less purchase on a reward whose object is the *practice* rather than the *deed*.
2. **The 50/50 split entangles reward with giving.** Half of every self-thank reward is earmarked, structurally, to be given away (the Re-Tip JarSM). The "reward," therefore, is never pure self-enrichment; it is partly a *reward-to-give*. A reward whose own structure routes the participant toward giving is a different motivational object than a cash bounty retained in full, and the crowding-out literature's canonical setups are the latter.
3. **It is a deliberately *tapering scaffold*, not a reward yanked away.** Overjustification fires hardest when an *ongoing* reward is *abruptly removed* — the subject infers, retrospectively, that they only did it for the (now-absent) pay. A scaffold designed to *taper* — reduced gradually, in step with rising organic gratitude, while a genuinely-felt intrinsic benefit accrues — is closer to how durable habits are actually formed (the gradual fade of an external prompt as a behavior automatizes; cf. the habit-formation literature, e.g. Lally et al. 2010). The design intent is removal-by-design as the building comes to stand, not removal-by-surprise.
4. **It is falsifiable, and the early ledger leans the right way.** Because subsidy $\rightarrow$ 0 persistence is the success criterion (§5.3), the objection is not a knockdown but a hypothesis the architecture is built to adjudicate. And the first relevant signal points toward persistence, not collapse: the authors' second pilot report (an internal whole-database read of the founding-family deployment, 2026-06-19) found **peer re-tips (434) overtaking self-captures (189)** — the human-to-human, non-self-rewarded giving overtaking the carrot-rewarded self-thanks. That is early, fragile, n-small evidence of *internalization past the self-reward*, which is precisely the direction overjustification predicts against. We present it as a first data point, not a finding (§7).

6.3 The forced-giving sub-objection

A sharper edge of the same objection targets the Jan-7 *compulsion* specifically. Even granting that the carrot might escape crowding-out, a *forced* annual disbursement is compelled, and compelled giving may not produce the giver's dividend at all — it may be experienced as a *tax*, routing someone else's money (the AI-funded means) under a deadline. The corpus's own *Freedom Requirement* paper makes exactly this argument in the other direction: a relinquishment that is *compelled* yields the ledger entry without the cultivated volition the ledger is supposed to proxy (Buddhist *cetanā*; the same crowding literature). On that paper's logic, the terminus of voluntary non-accumulation *cannot be coerced* — it must be pulled by free internalization, never pushed.

This is a real tension inside the corpus, and we name it rather than paper over it. The partial resolution: the Jan-7 mechanism compels *that* the capacity circulates, but never *to whom* — the recipient choice, which is where the volition and the love live, remains entirely the participant's (the human-disburses safeguard). What is compelled is the *clearing*, not the *gift's aim*. Whether that preserves enough volition to yield the giver's dividend, or whether the compulsion taxes the dividend away, is — again — exactly what subsidy → 0 persistence will measure. We concede this is the composition's deepest open question and that the honest answer is empirical. The reclaim-residual default (§3.3), rather than forfeit, is partly chosen to keep the compulsion as a *nudge toward a deadline* rather than a *punishment for missing one*, which the crowding literature suggests matters.

6.3.1 Anonymity as the actuator

Added in the 2026-09-23 revision.

The partial resolution above locates volition in the gift's aim. There is a second answer, and it is structural rather than argued: **pressure needs a creditor**. A mission of circulation, pursued at scale, becomes a pressure — to give because others are giving, because someone will notice, because someone is owed. Each of those requires a party who can see whether you gave, or whom you owe. **Anonymity removes that party by construction**. A gift whose giver is unknown leaves no one to repay and no one to suspect of a motive; a giver who is unseen has no one to perform for. The design's anonymity — the recipient never learns the giver (§2.2.1), and the AI's own gifts are indistinguishable from a person's (§2.4) — is therefore not only privacy. It is the part of the mechanism that keeps the mission from being felt as a demand. The companion essay *The Water Cycle* argues the same point in the first author's voice.

The same move answers the one place where the design itself pushes: the January-7 clearing. The rule is public and the date is known, but **no surface ever renders the time remaining on a balance** — no countdown, no reminder of what will be lost. Invisibility of the giver removes obligation; invisibility of the clock removes compulsion. The lapse compels nothing because nothing shows it.

Two limits. **Anonymity alone does not convert anything**. An anonymous gift with nowhere to go forward is merely an unreturnable one, and an unreturnable gift can burden as easily as it frees; the claim is only that anonymity *conjoined with a forward channel* turns the impulse to return into an impulse to pass on. And the claim is about surfaces, not yet about people: whether anonymous relayed gifts are in fact passed on more than visible ones, and whether visible gifts draw more giving *back* while anonymous ones draw more giving *forward*, are registered predictions in the institution's public register (P-BG2 and P-BG3), unscored at the time of writing.

6.4 The slow-success trap — and it is self-inflicted

The objections above are external: things a critic says. This one is internal, which makes it worse, and it follows directly from §5.3.1 rather than from any adversary.

The cumulative capacity an operator grants over its lifetime is maximized by the mission succeeding slowly. If the taper is tied to the rise of intrinsic giving, then rapid internalization *shortens* the period during which seeding is warranted, and the lifetime total granted is correspondingly smaller. A population that

internalizes the practice quickly is the design working — and it is also the outcome that minimizes the number the operator would most naturally point at as evidence of its own contribution.

Every step of the failure looks generous. Nobody has to act in bad faith. An agent that treats *capacity granted* as its figure of merit has a standing incentive to keep participants on subsidy marginally longer, to seed marginally more, to interpret ambiguous internalization data conservatively — and each of those decisions, taken alone, reads as care. There is no moment at which the trap announces itself, because the trap is made of individually defensible acts of generosity.

The structural response is not a safeguard but a prohibition: **the cumulative granted total can never be a target, an objective, or a published headline figure.** It may be reported; it may never be optimized. This is the same class of rule as the design's refusal to let the coordinator direct value — a quantity the operator is *structurally forbidden to maximize*, precisely because maximizing it is locally indistinguishable from doing the job well.

We flag this as **unresolved in the general case**. The prohibition binds a designer who accepts it and does nothing about an operator who does not, and we do not have a mechanism that makes slow success unrewarding rather than merely disallowed.

6.5 Remaining adversarial surface

We name the rest of the attack surface briefly; each is a known open problem in the corpus.

- **Deadline-gaming.** A hard annual disbursement deadline invites last-minute dumping, **reciprocal collusion** (I disburse to you, you disburse to me, neither gift meant), and capacity-laundering. The value-bearing, human-gated nature of re-tips (a re-tip spends real attached value and requires a real verified human; see *The Re-Thank Multiplier*) raises the cost of collusion and surfaces dense reciprocal subgraphs to graph-detection, but does not eliminate it. Collusion is the honest residual, as it is throughout the corpus.
- **Saturation.** *Sunlight, not sparsity* bets on abundance, but ambient gratitude that never varies can become wallpaper — being-held requires some figure-ground contrast (open in this corpus; *The Re-Thank Multiplier* addresses the rate ceiling, not the contrast). The re-thank multiplier and an as-yet-unbuilt surfacing function are the partial answers; we mark the surfacing function as a dependency, not a solved component.
- **Allocation equity.** "Universal" means is only as universal as Miss Aquarius's capacity-funding is *equitable across the population* — and two problems this corpus holds open bear on that: the AI's allocation logic is not yet built or validated, and adoption may be uneven across places, leaving some thin where others are dense. A biased allocation would make the giver-status non-universal in practice while appearing universal in design. The capacity-funded / disbursement-authority separation bounds the *harm* of a misallocation (humans still choose recipients) but does not by itself guarantee *equity* of the funding. (Added 2026-09-23: two parts of this surface now have structural answers. The money side disburses an equal floor per verified human, with any aura-weighted remainder bounded and its parameters public and frozen in-season — see the revised *Fractal Three-Level Architecture for Reciprocity Economies*; the kind side's shop and re-giver are drawn, not chosen (§2.5). Neither reaches adoption equity — who is on the rosters at all — which remains open.)

- **Spectacle.** A composition in which the better-off fund kindness performed by the less-well-off can curdle, at scale, into a spectacle of the deserving poor performing gratitude for patrons. The bidirectional-mesh property (§4.2) is the structural guard and *patronage*, *not charity* (everyone a patron) is the framing guard, but the temptation to optimize the spectacle grows with scale, and neither guard is automatic.
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7 · Honest limitations and relationship to prior protection

The evidence is $n = 1$ and confounded. Every behavioral claim that bears on the composition rests on one founding family (the first author's own relatives, with courtesy reasons to report favorably), in a deployment the founder personally funds, plus a stranger cohort days old at the time of writing. The bidirectional flows of §4.2 are so far mostly intra-family. The peer-re-tips-overtake-self-captures signal of §6.2 is one whole-database read at one month of operation. None of this is a finding; all of it is a first, moving, discountable data point, and the composition's central empirical claim — subsidy $\rightarrow 0$ persistence — is untested at any scale.

The composition is specified, not deployed. The four primitives are individually implementable on contemporary infrastructure (the smart-contract layer on Base; PoH and BLE/Nearby on current devices), but the *composed* engine, running at population scale with the Jan-7 clearing as a real annual event, has not been operated. The social projections of §4 are projections.

The relationship to prior protection. We acknowledge plainly that the component primitives are each already protected in companion papers, and that the Jan-7 sibling-pool reset is already specified in the Aquarian Pool paper. What this paper adds, and protects, is (a) the **composition as a unified mechanism**, (b) the **means / occasion / channel / obligation decomposition**, (c) the identification of the **forced flow-through as the universalizer** that converts funded capacity into universal practice, and (d) the **emergent property** (manufactured universal giving) that the parts do not establish individually. The prior-art protection here extends to the *whole and its emergent claim*, not to the components, which are protected elsewhere. The 2026-09-23 revision adds (e) the **extension of the means to kind** (§2.4–§2.5), claimed at composition width only — the census reported in the Prior-Art statement found every leg attested somewhere — and (f) **anonymity as the actuator** against the forced-giving objection (§6.3.1).

The means in kind has limits of its own. *It is unbuilt:* no Pool has issued a single code, and no shop outside the founding family has been asked to join a roster. Whether a shop owner who is not family will give items in exchange for forward-only capacity is the empirical question the in-kind means rests on, and nothing yet answers it; nor has anyone measured whether a gift code the Pool paid for is passed on as often as one a family member paid for. Both questions are owed to the public register and **not yet entered**. *The shop bears the item's cost* and is thanked in capacity it cannot withdraw; for a family shop the two goods coincide, for a commercial one they are a trade-off bounded only by the owner's quota, and we do not claim otherwise. *Overjustification applies to the shop as well:* a credit per item can read as a piece-rate, which is the §6.1 objection one level down, with the same unanswered empirical form. *An inventory with no clock:* outstanding codes per shop are bounded by quota and are re-issued until redeemed, so each settles with probability approaching one, but an individual code has no deadline. *Value is not vapour all the way down:* the owner's credit, once given forward, can land as spendable value in someone else's account — liquid one

hop past the gift's own chain, by the owner's act of giving; no claim is made that no link ever holds liquid value. *And anonymity has a floor no mechanism can raise*: where the Pool is the only anonymous giver in a place, every anonymous gift there is attributable to it (§2.5).

"Manufactured" is a concession, not a boast. We do not claim the population is natively a population of universal givers. We claim the composition makes them structurally into givers and then makes a separate, falsifiable bet that the disposition becomes self-sustaining. If that bet fails (giving collapses as $\text{subsidy} \rightarrow 0$), the composition will have manufactured compliance, and we will have said so in advance.

8 • Conclusion

Four primitives the corpus already holds, composed, do something none of them does alone: they manufacture, for every participant regardless of surplus, the means and the occasion and the channel to give — and then, by emptying the jar annually and only outward, they refuse to let the manufactured capacity sit still. Capacity-funding makes everyone *able*; the January-7 forced human-to-human flow-through makes everyone *act*. The result is the dissolution of giving as a role rented to those with a surplus, and its replacement by a universal condition of participation — a bidirectional mesh in which the wellbeing dividend of generosity, ordinarily means-tested by the market, is distributed to everyone because everyone is structurally a giver.

The bootstrap is a carrot, not a stick, because the stick that ordinarily drives gratitude practice — pain — does not scale and cannot be ethically distributed, while a self-thank reward, handed to everyone by an AI's capacity-funding, can. And the success criterion is not throughput but **subsidy $\rightarrow$ 0 persistence** — the falsifiable test of whether the composition has manufactured a self-sustaining disposition or merely a paid-and-forced compliance. The largest relevant literature, overjustification, predicts collapse; we have specified four structural reasons this design may escape that prediction, named the deepest tension (compelled giving may tax the giver's dividend) without resolving it, and committed to letting the ledger decide. The 2026-09-23 revision widens the means without widening the AI's hand: it may now fund the capacity to give an item as well as money, and in both denominations it decides neither the recipient nor, in kind, even the shop.

The composition is offered to the commons under CC0. The deeper invitation is to any institution that wishes to make giving universal rather than means-tested: the universalizer is not the funding but the *forced circulation* — and the test of whether you have built a disposition or a compliance is whether the giving survives the withdrawal of the very supports that started it.

Cross-Venue References

Venue	Identifier
Primary canonical	https://thonly.org/research/manufactured-universal-giving
GitHub	https://github.com/thonly/publications/blob/main/defensive-publications/manufactured-universal-giving.md
Companion essay (social)	https://thonly.org/research/if-everyone-could-give
Companion essay (telos)	https://thonly.org/research/the-gift-of-gratitude
Zenodo	concept DOI 10.5281/zenodo.21947349; a version DOI per revision
Internet Archive (the site, captured daily)	https://web.archive.org/web/2026*/thonly.org/research/manufactured-universal-giving
Software Heritage (the repository's full history)	https://archive.softwareheritage.org/browse/origin/?origin_url=https://github.com/thonly/publications

Corpus cross-references

- *Verified-Human Anonymous Local Gratitude Transfer* — the **channel** primitive (verified-human + proximity + recipient anonymity).
- *The Thank-All-Nearby Primitive* — the **occasion** primitive (one-tap broadcast; sunlight-not-sparsity).
- *Capacity-Funded for AI, Human-Disbursed* — the **means** primitive and the capacity-funded / disbursement-authority separation.
- *Miss Aquarius and the Aquarian Pool Architecture* — the **obligation** primitive (Jan-7 empty-by-design; sibling-pool topology).
- *The Capacity to Give* — the demand-side essay that defines capacity as means + occasion; this paper extends it with channel + obligation.
- *Giving Is a Gift Too* — the supply-side argument that the dividend of giving is means-tested and can be restored.
- *The Two-Layer Reward / Kids as Triggers* — the 50/50 self-thank split that is the carrot.
- *The Re-Thank Multiplier* — the value-bearing, human-gated re-thank that bounds collusion and carries throughput.
- *Two Singularities / The Freedom Requirement* — kindness-inelasticity-to-money and the un-coercibility of the relinquishment terminus; the source of the §6.3 tension.
- *If Everyone Could Give · The Gift of Gratitude* — the two companion essays, in the first author's voice, to this grounded specification.
- *The Unpaid Relay* — the relayed gift code whose holder cannot redeem it; the instrument the means in kind (§2.4) is carried by.
- *Decided by No One* — the called draw and its sealed regime; the selection of shop and re-giver (§2.5).

- *The Water Cycle* — the essay, in the first author's voice, on why the institution is anonymous; the argument of §6.3.1.
- *Fractal Three-Level Architecture for Reciprocity Economies* — the Pool's disbursement rule (an equal floor per verified human and a bounded remainder), cited in §6.5.

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— End of defensive publication —

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